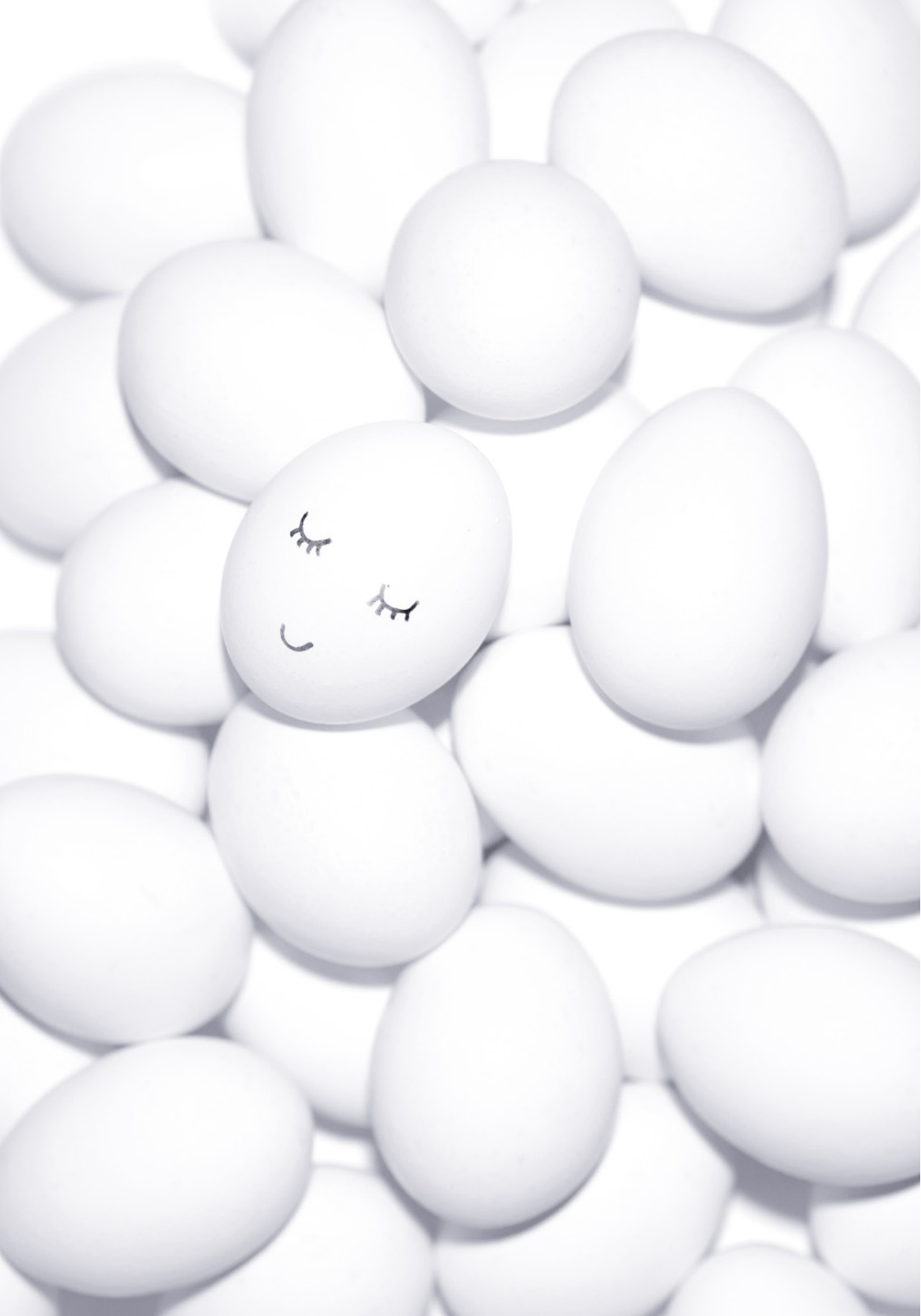




HOW TO CREATE VISUALS

PRINCIPLES AND PRACTICE

Author: Hiromitsu Ishii
Art Direction & Design: Hiromitsu Ishii
Creative Dialogue Partner: ChatGPT

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info@kream.jp

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Some content in this book was developed
with the assistance of ChatGPT.

HOW TO CREATE
VISUALS

**PRINCIPLES AND
PRACTICE**

BY HIROMITSU ISHII

WHAT DO YOU SEE? WHAT DO YOU IMAGINE?



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Stepping into the next phase of Creating Visuals.



Photo: Juan Burgos

Written and Design by **Hiromitsu Ishii**
Creative Dialogue Partner: **ChatGPT**

BEFORE WE BEGIN

This book is for anyone struggling to create visuals.

- You need to create visuals for work or teaching, but you're not sure how
- You are learning design, but still can't apply it in real situations
- Your visuals don't stand out at work—even though you know they should

This book is designed to help you.

It introduces the fundamental concepts behind creating visuals, and guides you through simple exercises so you can apply them in any situation.

Discover a logical method that empowers anyone to build stunning visuals—without relying on “innate sense” alone.

You will learn how to create visuals through “Words”—and take part in the process with confidence.



EPILOGUE

In today's world,
VISUALS dominate
our attention.
How visuals “stand out”
has become important
to everyone.



Take a look at the two images.
You'll probably get different impressions.
The difference is small, but the impact is not.

In today's world, VISUALS dominate our attention. Social media spreads it instantly, and AI generates visual information quickly. In this massive and fast-paced environment, how visuals "stand out" has become important to everyone.

If you work in marketing, product development, or any field where visual information is crucial, you've probably experienced this:

You know something's not working, but you can't explain why.

You need to create visuals, but you don't know where to start.

Or, you have a vague image in your head, but you don't know how to handle it.

When I started working as an art director,
I faced these problems many times. I wasn't
quite sure how I should take the lead.
So I would say things like,
"A little more...natural...?" or "A more fun...?"
But those words didn't work at all.

To solve this problem, I changed my approach.
What changed was "words."

I "verbalized" the visual concept and
"visualized" those words. By systematically
designing the visual concept and putting its
intentions into words, I was able to clarify the
team's direction and consistently produce more
powerful visuals.

Later, I developed this approach into workshops.
The participants included students, people from
various professions, and people of all ages.
After the workshop, many participants told me,
"My perspective has changed," and "I'm looking

forward to creating things from now on.”

This book offers a simple, accessible way to create visuals. All that’s needed is not to look at things straight on, but to look at them from various angles. You can expect to find more “perspectives” and expand the breadth of your ideas many times over.

And that will enrich your visual expression.

Finding many perspectives also leads to a broader enjoyment of life.

I hope this book is a continuous series of discoveries and a fun journey for everyone.

You can expect to find
more “perspectives.”

And that will enrich your
visual expression.



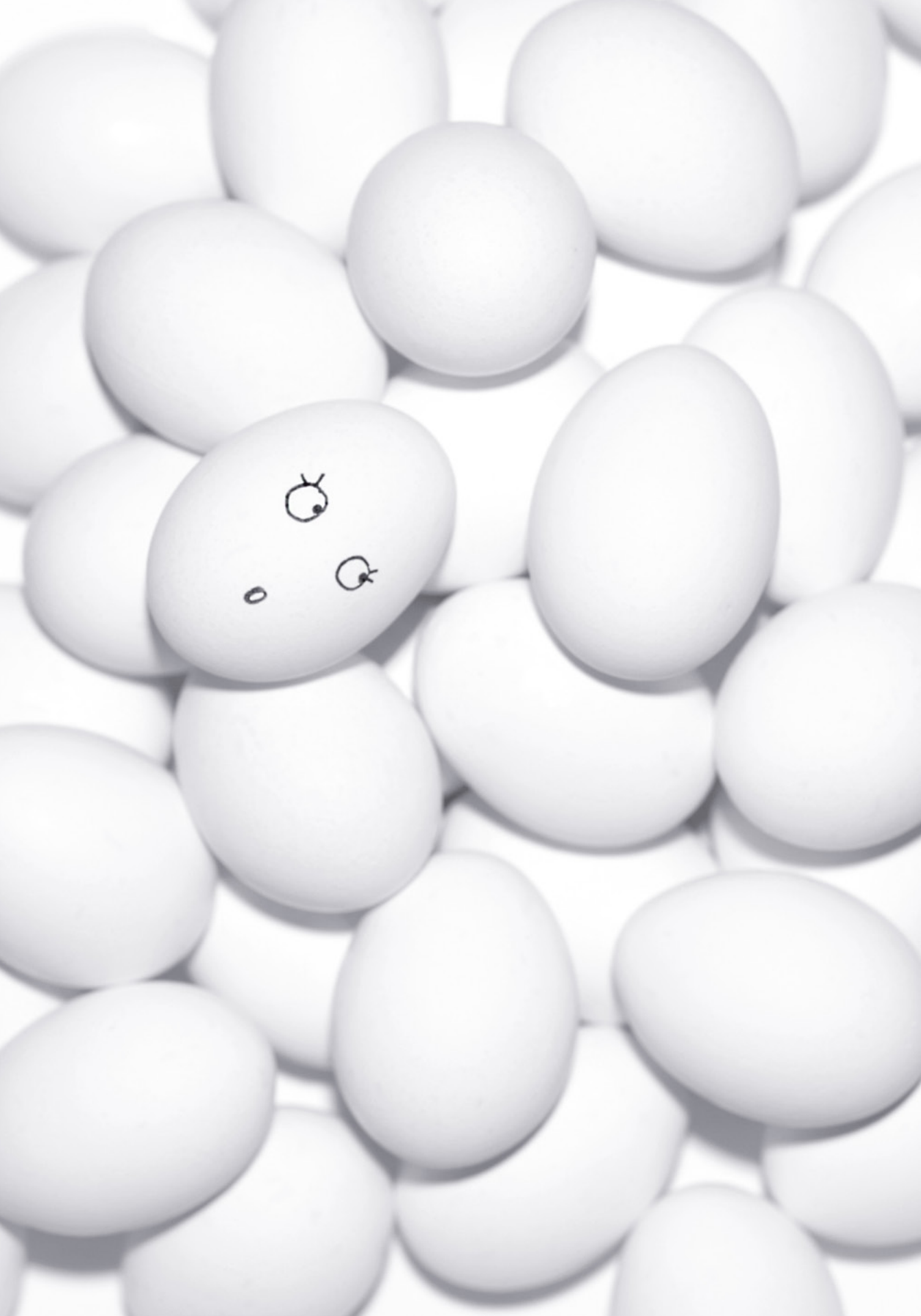
**CREATIVITY
IS NOT
TALENT.
IT IS
PERSPECTIVE.**

Many people enjoy looking at
photographs and paintings.
Yet only a few take that
step to create something
themselves, often believing:
“I’m not talented enough.”

This book was created to
challenge that belief.
It is for creators, designers,
educators, and anyone
who wants to express ideas
visually — even those who
have never thought of
themselves as “creative.”
Visual expression is not a gift
given to a few.

It is a way of seeing, thinking,
and shaping ideas that
anyone can learn.





ARE YOU AWAKE?

LET'S GET STARTED.

MAKE IT VISIBLE

In a way, the age of AI is cruel.

There was a time when only a select few created visuals, and the equipment needed to produce them wasn't easily accessible.

But nowadays, someone across the desk might ask you,

"Can you generate that image with AI?"
as if they were asking you to bring them a cup of coffee.

There's no point in lamenting it. But if you look at it positively, your possibilities are expanding. So why not just enjoy getting involved in visual creation?

Track 1: **F O U N D A T I O N**

Photo: Graphic Node



Analyzing the language of visuals and how they speak to us.

You think through what you see.

A photo posted by a friend on social media can make you feel happy, envious, or irritated—sometimes you might even find yourself judging them without realizing it.

Strange, isn't it?

Just one image can quietly change how you feel about someone. Why does this happen?

If you begin to understand this mechanism, you will start to see how visuals truly work.

Notice what you feel before you understand.



VISUAL EXERCISE

Find the differences between the two photos and describe what each situation suggests.



A girl in the photo is...

WHERE **In a room**

WHAT **Listening to music
with headphones**

B



A girl in the photo is...

WHERE In a room or cafe?

WHAT Listening to music
with headphones Having
coffee.

Alone? with a friend??

A



A girl in the photo is...

WHERE **Indoors**

WHAT **Listening to music
with headphones**

B



A girl in the photo is...

WHERE	Indoors → Gym?
WHAT	Listening to music with headphones wiping sweat. After exercising? or yoga?

A



A man in the photo is...

WHERE **In a cafe**

WHAT **Listening to music with
headphones**

B



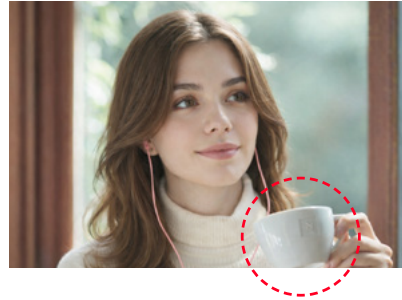
A man in the photo is...

WHERE In a cafe or restaurant?

WHAT Listening to music with
headphones with a bouquet.

waiting for someone?

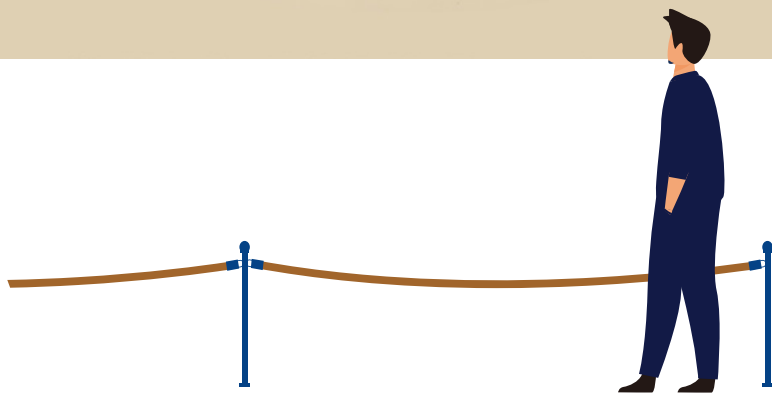
Subtle differences can alter the context.



Did you notice the subtle differences between the photos and begin to imagine the situations they suggest?

The girl holding a coffee cup might be at a café. The woman wiping away sweat — perhaps she just finished exercising. The man holding flowers may be waiting for someone special.

Without realizing it, you compared what you saw with your own daily experiences and memories. In other words, visuals are built from pieces of “information.” We interpret that information instantly, and it quietly shapes what we understand and feel.



V I S U A L S =

I N F O R M A T I O N .

Every visual is built from pieces of information
within the frame.

Catch a glimpse of what's behind it.

Visuals play a much bigger role in our lives than we realize. From television to posters, billboards, and packaging design, the internet, social media, to AI... We take in vast amounts of information visually and process it in our brains.

As you know, visuals are not created by chance, but crafted with a specific purpose in mind. Even visuals that seem ordinary at first glance may hide unexpected “tricks” if you look closely.

Take another look. You might catch a glimpse of the message behind it.

Ideally, we'd like to cultivate the ability to see things clearly and reduce unnecessary stress.

